

Flower Dedication

The flowers adorning the sanctuary this morning are given in loving memory of John Burnett and Ed Barnes on Ed’s birthday. — *Brandon Lowrey*

Announcements

Women’s Ministry Overview Meeting. *Today · 1:30 p.m. · Youth House.* Come hear Laura Kate’s plan for ministry at FPC and be a part of being disciples and making disciples among women. All are welcome.

Samaritan’s Purse Shoeboxes. Collection boxes are available in the children’s wing and the side entrance by the church office. You can participate by shopping and collecting items, or by donating monetarily — each shoebox costs \$10 to ship. Items needed: small composition notebooks, pencils, small cars/trucks, puzzles, jump ropes, hair bows/barrettes/brushes/combs, underwear in larger sizes, and small stuffed animals. No liquids, candy, or food!

Those Who Serve Today

Assisting Elder — Ken Williams

Greeters — Nick & Heather Ashmore

Acolytes — Hadley Howell & Julianne Whittington

Circle of Prayer — Alberto Albarracin & Malechi Doren

Children’s Church — Nate & Sara Beth Alexander

AV Engineer — Russell Smith

Ushers — Dave Shanklin, Peter Fisher, Cameron Crockett, JR Burns, & Nick Ashmore

Nursery — Deborah Kiddy, Jackie Capps, Morgan Williams, Katty Albarracin, Anna Erwin, & Joshua & Brittany Bryant

Church Staff

Rev. Waring Porter - Pastor

Gregg Parker - Dir. of Discipleship

Bobby Capps - Dir. of Outreach & Care

Jennifer Shipp - Dir. of Student Ministries

Laura Kate Carmichiel - Dir. of Women’s Min. & Comm.

Phyllis Sellers - Day School Director

Jan Pike - Choir Director

Malechi Doren - Accompanist

Teresa Tsagarakis - Administrative Assistant

Sammy Allred - Bookkeeper

The Church Calendar

September 13 Session Meeting · Deacons’ Meeting · Women’s Ministry Overview Meeting, 1:30 p.m., Youth House

September 15 Women’s Bible Study — Youth House, 8 a.m.

September 16 KidsQuest · Youth · Women’s Bible Study, 6 p.m.

September 17 MI3 Week 6

September 17 Joy Riders Lunch — Pickwick State Park

Sept. 26 – Oct. 3 Roca Blanca Mission Trip

Sept. 29 – Oct. 2 LeConte Pilgrimage

October 7 Outdoor Movie Night: *Mary Poppins*, 6:30 p.m.

Online Giving



Scan to give online



FIRST PRESBYTERIAN CHURCH

September 13, 2026

Sixteenth Sunday after Pentecost

“To be disciples, to make disciples”

Welcome

We Are Glad You Are Here!

We are honored that you decided to join us this morning. Whether it is your first time in church, your first time in a long while, or part of your regular rhythm, we hope you will be encouraged by the fellowship with each other, and with our Lord, as we worship him together.

If this is your first time with us, please take a moment and fill out a Next Steps Card found on the back of the pew. We would love to meet you and help you get connected.

Children & Nursery

Children (age 4+) and their families worship together in the sanctuary, where children will be dismissed to Children’s Church during the service. Children’s bulletins and crayons are available at both entrances to the Sanctuary. Children are always welcome in worship!

Nursery rooms for infants through age 3 are in the Education Wing, with the entrance behind the playground on the west side of campus. If you have a newborn and/or are nursing your baby, please feel free to use our baby room just off the narthex — a quiet space with comfortable seating where the worship service is broadcast as well.

Our Vision & Mission

Our vision is to see lives transformed by the power of the gospel, rooted in God’s Word and the Reformed tradition, in order to create a culture of discipleship at FPC where disciples WORSHIP holistically, GROW relationally in Christ, and SERVE boldly in the world for the glory of God. Our mission is to accomplish this by “Being Disciples and Making Disciples.”

Connect With Us

Website: fpccorinth.org
Phone: 662-286-6638
Address: 919 East Shiloh Rd, Corinth, MS 38834

Sermon Outline

“Restored by Grace: Faithful Stewards”

Rev. Waring Porter · Ezra 8:24–36

One of the funniest things about human beings is how quickly we can turn something we’ve merely been given access to into something we think we actually own. We have a remarkable tendency to confuse having something with owning something. Psalm 24 reminds us, “The earth is the LORD’s and the fullness thereof.” Everything belongs to Him.

Ezra has entrusted these priests with something incredibly valuable: silver, gold, and vessels dedicated to the worship of God. But Ezra wants them to understand something very clearly: This isn’t your stuff. You have been entrusted with them. Your job is to guard them, keep them, and faithfully deliver them to the place God has appointed. This brings us to the focus of this passage: Because God has entrusted His holy things to His redeemed people, He calls us to be faithful stewards with accountability, integrity, and faithfulness for His glory.

I. Accountability: It Belongs to God (vv. 24–27)

II. Integrity: We Live Before God (vv. 28–30)

III. Stewardship: We Serve God Faithfully (vv. 31–36)

Resources: Matthew Henry’s Commentary, Vol. 2, Matthew Henry; Ezra & Nehemiah, Derek Kidner; Ezra & Nehemiah, Jacob M. Myers; Westminster Confession of Faith

FPC MISSIONS
FPC will be sending a team to serve at Roca Blanca Mission base in Oaxaca, Mexico, the week of Sept. 26 – Oct. 3. Amanda Tomlin will be serving in Guaimaca, Honduras, with Baptist Medical and Dental Mission International (BMDMI) during the week of Sept. 19–26.

Commissioning and Prayer for Missionaries

Roca Blanca Mission Team
Amanda Tomlin

LITURGY FOR THE WORSHIP OF GOD

September 13, 2026

* Indicates congregation standing if able

Our worship is a covenant conversation between God and His people. Throughout the service, God graciously speaks to us through His Word, and we joyfully respond with praise, confession, prayer, faith, thanksgiving, and obedience.

GATHERING

The Piano Prelude

Greetings & Announcements

Call to Meditation: 1 Chronicles 29:11

“Yours, O Lord, is the greatness and the power and the glory and the victory and the majesty, for all that is in the heavens and in the earth is yours. Yours is the kingdom, O Lord, and you are exalted as head above all.”

The Prelude

Choral Introit

“Glorify Thy Name”

CALL TO WORSHIP
We are summoned to worship by God’s word, calling His people into His presence to honor Him in spirit and truth, opening a sacred conversation that unfolds throughout the service. We sing in response to God’s call to worship, which is a reminder that worship is at God’s initiative, not ours.

*Call to Worship: 1 Chronicles 29:10–13

Leader: Blessed are you, O Lord, the God of Israel our father, forever and ever. Yours, O Lord, is the greatness and the power and the glory and the victory and the majesty, for all that is in the heavens and in the earth is yours.

All: Yours is the kingdom, O Lord, and you are exalted as head above all.

Leader: Both riches and honor come from you, and you rule over all. In your hand are power and might, and in your hand it is to make great and to give strength to all.

All: And now we thank you, our God, and praise your glorious name.

ALL CREATURES OF OUR GOD AND KING
The hymn was written by Francis of Assisi around 1225. Drawing on the Psalms, Francis called the sun, moon, wind, water, earth, and all creatures to praise God. The familiar tune, LASST UNS ERFREUEN, dates to the seventeenth century. This joyful hymn is especially fitting for today’s liturgy: Before we consider our stewardship, we first remember that everything belongs to God and that all creation is called to praise its Creator. As we sing, we join the great chorus of creation, acknowledging that God is the giver and owner of all things, and therefore the rightful recipient of our praise and our lives.

WORD

Scripture Reading

Ezra 8:24–36 · Pew Bible, p. 395

Scripture Response: Isaiah 40:6b, 8

Leader: All flesh is grass, and all its beauty is like the flower of the field;
All: The grass withers, the flower fades, but the Word of our God will stand forever.
Amen.

Sermon: “Restored by Grace: Faithful Stewards”

Rev. Waring Porter

Prayer of Commitment

SENDING

*Closing Hymn: #620

“We Give Thee but Thine Own”

*Benediction

*Choral Benediction

Threefold Amen

*Postlude

BENEDICTION
God’s people are blessed by the Lord and sent forth into the world, bearing with them the hope and peace of the Gospel. This should remind us that God doesn’t just meet with us when we gather, but He goes with us as we scatter. As we continue our worship, we do so as people sent to our community for reconciliation, bearing witness to the good news of the gospel.

*The Hymn: #64

“All Creatures of Our God and King” (vv. 1–3)

*Prayer of Invocation & The Lord’s Prayer

Our Father, who art in heaven, hallowed be thy Name. Thy Kingdom come, thy will be done on earth, as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread, and forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors. Lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom, the power, and the glory, forever. Amen.

*The Psalter Reading: Psalm 24

Leader: The earth is the Lord’s and the fullness thereof, the world and those who dwell therein, for he has founded it upon the seas and established it upon the rivers. Who shall ascend the hill of the Lord? And who shall stand in his holy place?

All: He who has clean hands and a pure heart, who does not lift up his soul to what is false and does not swear deceitfully.

Leader: He will receive blessing from the Lord and righteousness from the God of his salvation. Such is the generation of those who seek him, who seek the face of the God of Jacob. Lift up your heads, O gates! And be lifted up, O ancient doors, that the King of glory may come in.

All: Who is this King of glory? The Lord, strong and mighty, the Lord, mighty in battle!

Leader: Lift up your heads, O gates! Lift them up, O ancient doors, that the King of glory may come in.

All: Who is this King of glory? The Lord of hosts, he is the King of glory!

*Congregational Response: #64 “All Creatures of Our God and King” (vv. 4–5)

Corporate Prayer of Confession

Gracious God, we confess that we have not been faithful stewards of all that You have entrusted to us. We have treated Your gifts as our own, used our resources for ourselves rather than for Your glory, and neglected opportunities to serve others and advance Your kingdom. Forgive us for our greed, our self-reliance, and our lack of gratitude. Teach us to recognize that all we have belongs to You. Give us generous hearts, wise hands, and faithful lives, that we might gladly use our time, talents, and treasures for Your glory and the good of others. Through Jesus Christ our Lord, we pray.

Silent Confession

Assurance of Divine Pardon: 2 Corinthians 8:9

“For you know the grace of our Lord Jesus Christ, that though he was rich, yet for your sake he became poor, so that you by his poverty might become rich.”

*Gloria Patri

Glory be to the Father, and to the Son, and to the Holy Ghost; As it was in the beginning, is now, and ever shall be: world without end. Amen.

*Profession of Faith: The Apostles’ Creed

I believe in God, the Father almighty, Maker of heaven and earth, and in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord, who was conceived by the Holy Ghost, born of the Virgin Mary, suffered under Pontius Pilate, was crucified, dead and buried; he descended into hell; the third day he rose again from the dead; he ascended into heaven, and sitteth on the right hand of God the Father Almighty; from thence he shall come to judge the quick and the dead. I believe in the Holy Ghost, the holy catholic Church, the communion of saints, the forgiveness of sins, the resurrection of the body, and the life everlasting. Amen.*

**that is, the true Christian church of all times and all places*

dGroup Story of Grace

George Huttick

DGROUP

A group of 3–5 same-gender individuals, led by a trained disciple-maker, that meets regularly to encourage one another as Christ-followers to continue taking steps in becoming a disciple of Christ who makes other disciples.

The Giving of Tithes and Offerings

Choral Anthem

“Shoutin’ Time”

Traditional, arr. Bradley Knight

*The Doxology and Prayer of Dedication

Praise God, from whom all blessings flow; Praise Him, all creatures here below; Praise Him above, ye heavenly host; Praise Father, Son, and Holy Ghost. Amen.

*Children Dismissed to Children’s Church

CHILDREN’S CHURCH

Children ages 4 up to 4th grade are invited to come forward and exit out the side door for Children’s Church. Following the worship service, they may be picked up in the Fellowship Hall.

CORPORATE
CONFESSION

Our corporate confession of sin is a three-fold acknowledgement that the world is not the way it was meant to be; I am not the way I was meant to be; and we as a church are not the way we were meant to be. As we acknowledge our failures together, we testify to the world that the gospel is rooted in the faithful mercy of God alone. This is the most honest moment of our week, as we humbly agree with Scripture’s claim that all have sinned and fall short of the glory of God.